

Many people are creative enough to come up with trending topics, but lack the sheer number of followers to actually start a trend. It is, therefore, advisable to pair up with people who can actually influence a large number of people so as to have a better chance at trending.

Another advisable thing to do is use a unique hashtag. The charm that fresh content possesses isn't captured by recycled content.

- ◆ Moving on to timing. While it isn't as hard as content is, it is equally important. If you were to try to trend around 9pm on a weekday, you would have to compete with all the television channels that telecast new episodes of their shows. Similarly, if you were trying to trend something to do with the local weather during the FIFA World Cup, you might now find any major success.
- ◆ Something that most people get wrong is how to give instructions for a hashtag. When the instructions itself are vague, the tweets will be too scattered to form a good trend. To avoid making such a mistake you can do several things. If there was to be a interactive seminar organized by your brand or company, you could ask all the participants to use a personalized hashtag during the seminar to ask the questions they want answered. You should also give out clear examples to avoid any sort of confusion whatsoever.

Apart from that, you could always offer incentives. It is common practice for large organizations to offer some sort of prize for any number of reasons – be it like a lucky draw contest of all the people who used the hashtag, the most innovative answer, or just the first person to reply. New restaurants promise free meals, bars offer free drink, and so on. It is a common practice only because it is very successful in creating a buzz. If you were to have any sort of incentive to offer, your hashtag might just take a life of its own.

- ◆ As with any public sourced entity, it is recommended to keep track of all your attempts to trend a hashtag – successes or failures. An easy way to do that is to use SocialSprout, a tool that allows you to keep track of the number of tweets sent out and the number of conversations that took place around your hashtag. You can use this to build a database for future use.
- ◆ Know what you want to do with the hashtag. Decide whether you want to create awareness, and what kind of awareness you want to create. It could vary from the effects of a global pandemic, to the new Nike shoes. Whatever your campaign, have a plan.